

Week 09

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Documentation

Draft Project Statement

This project explores the relationship between phone usage and emotional wellbeing by creating an interactive digital visualisation of personal screen time data. By combining phone usage information with self-recorded emotional states, the project aims to reveal patterns that often go unnoticed in everyday life.

The project is based on the idea that phones have become deeply integrated into daily routines, yet many people may not fully recognise how emotions influence their digital behaviours. Through visualising these connections, the project asks whether making invisible habits visible can encourage greater awareness and reflection.

The final artefact will be an interactive emotional timeline that visually maps phone usage throughout the day using colour-coded emotional states. Users will be able to explore patterns such as high usage periods, emotional changes throughout the day, and repeated behaviours like scrolling late at night when feeling tired or stressed.

Rather than simply presenting data, the goal of this project is to create an experience that encourages people to think more critically about their relationship with their phones and how everyday digital habits may influence emotional wellbeing.

Evaluation Notes

What is working well?

The project has a clear focus on emotions and phone habits The idea feels personally relevant and relatable The interactive visualisation supports the goal of reflection

What is missing or underdeveloped?

More detail is needed on how emotional data will be recorded consistently The project could explain more clearly why visualisation is the best approach Ethical considerations around personal data still need more development

What feels overly generalised or AI-like?

Some ideas around "reflection" could be more specific The future context could be explained in more detail The project could include more personal motivation behind the topic

What do you need to research further?

Existing research on screen time and emotional wellbeing Different methods for visualising emotional data Interactive design techniques for exploration and filtering Ways to structure personal datasets effectively

Commitment Sentence

I will create an interactive digital experience that helps reveal emotional patterns behind everyday phone habits and encourages users to reflect on behaviours they may not normally notice.

Independent Study

Project Development Reflection

Over the past week, I continued developing my project by focusing on how emotional data and phone usage could be combined into a visual format. Building on the making sprint, I created a small sample dataset using screen time information and experimented with different timeline layouts in Figma. This helped me better understand how emotional states could be represented visually without making the interface confusing or overwhelming.

One of the biggest developments was shifting the project from simply creating a timeline into creating an interactive digital experience. Feedback from peers suggested that interaction could make patterns easier to explore and create stronger engagement with the data. As a result, I started experimenting with ideas such as hover interactions, filtering emotions, and displaying additional information only when selected.

Throughout this process, I realised that collecting emotional data consistently may be one of the most difficult parts of the project. I also learnt that simplifying emotional categories is important because too many categories can make the visualisation difficult to understand.

This stage of development has helped move the project from an abstract idea into something more practical and testable while also highlighting areas that still need refinement.